MILITARY POWER AS A TECHNIQUE OF FOREIGN POLICY

According to Garnett[35] the term 'military power' refers to the capacity of a state to kill, maim, coerce and destroy. Though there may be contenders of states in matters of use of violence as a means to attain specific goals yet it is usually accepted, till date, that military power and its use is exercised by states and used primarily by governments to protect their countries from external aggression and internal subversion. Even the Charter of the United Nations under Article 51 acknowledges the use of force in self-defence. According to the Article nothing in the present Charter shall impair the inherent right of individual or collective self-defence if an armed attack occurs against a Member of the United Nations, until the Security Council has taken necessary measures to maintain international peace and security. Military power is therefore, "the legally sanctioned instrument of violence that governments use in their relations with each other, and, when necessary, in an internal security role".

From this definition, two assumptions can be derived. One is that military power is a purposive and second is that it is a functional thing. It is functional because it is one of the many instruments in the orchestra of power that states use at various times in pursuit of their national interests. It is purposive because use of military power, which results in war or acts of aggression, is not always used as an instrument of policy but as a purposive political act.

If the international system is thought to be like the Hobbesian 'state of nature', following the realists, then to survive in that ungoverned environment, military power has proved to be a powerful weapon. Therefore, the use of military power as a rational technique for pursuing foreign policy has been accepted under such situations of insecurity. Its frequent use determines not who is right, but who is going to prevail in the constant struggle for prosperity, prestige and security. Michael Howard suggested "the capacity of states to defend themselves, and their evident willingness to do so, provides the basic framework within which the business of international negotiations is carried on". Military power is an intrinsic part of the